

Species: PURPLE FINCH

Carpodacus purpureus

(Vernacular Name)

(Scientific Name-use binomial)

Date(s): Dec. 5, 1974 just about every day up to present time, March 20, 1975

Locality: 53 Rio Vista Circle Durango

Nearest Town: Durango

County: La Plata

Other observers who independently identified this bird:

NAME	ADDRESS	TELEPHONE
Preston Somers	864 E. 6th Durango	247-4085
Marlene Pixler	465 San Juan Drive	247-2023
Kip Stransky	175 W. 29th Dgo.	247-8138

TELEPHONE

Optical Equipment: 7X35 Baush&Lomb, SLR Sears 35mm camera-9 to 10 ft. taken with
If photographed, type of equipment used: 104 lens & 2X-37 ft. with 500 Vivitar & 2X
Light Conditions: All types (pictures fair to good but through thermopanel)
Distance from bird (how measured): 7 ft. to 37 ft. measured (tape) & camera lens

Number of Birds Seen: one Sex: female Plumage: adult

Describe the bird's overall behavior and demeanor:

Comes with the House Finches but is more shy-, and comes more erratic.
Otherwise the bird feeds and acts like the other finches.

Describe in great detail the bird's size, overall shape, plumage and color-pattern.
Include details on shape of bill, wings and tail. Give particular emphasis to the marks
you used to identify the bird. Reference to its resemblance in field guide descriptions
is not enough. Describe what you actually saw in the field:

Slightly larger than House Finch and more sleek and isn't quite so "chunky"
as the Cassin's Finch. It has a very definite forked tail- between legs
and undertail coverts is white. Has heavy side streaks-white and dark
gray streaks Very Bold-(The photos do not do justice to this particular
coloring) Also has bold light (nearly white) eyeline outlining a dark
cheek patch.

Back is brown streaked with dark gray.

Eyes, bill and legs are dark horn colored Banded on right leg. No eye
ring. It has no wing bards but feathers are edged light. Flanks are
boldly streaked-white and very dark gray.

Can't see any comparable difference between this finche's bill and the
Cassin's Finch.

The main marks used to identify the bird are the heavy head markings.

(OVER)

Describe the bird's song or call, if heard, including method of delivery, i.e., from perch, in flight, etc:

I never did hear the bird.

Describe the habitat in which you observed this bird: This bird came to my feeder first December 5 but stayed only a short while-The she came back Dec 18 and is still coming (March 20) almost every day. However she would disappear a few days or a week or so at a time only to come back. I have sat within 12 ft. of her many times and looked at her with and without my binoculars she was so close.
~~How were similarly appearing species eliminated?~~

Similar species were eliminated by the head markings as well as the bold streaks. This is true of the House Finch. Cassin's Finches aren't so sleek, they are more chunky. Nor are they so boldly streaked-- There were no Cassin's Finches around except off and on through out the winter. This finch always traveled with the House Finches and the only finch with such a bold facial pattern.

Prior experience with this and similarly appearing species:

None with the Purple Finch, extensive with Cassin's and House Finches.

Books, illustrations and advice consulted and how did these influence this documentation?

I read about everything I could find- namely: Peterson's Western Bird Guide, Birds of North America, Birds of Colorado, Audubon's Bird Guides and Dr. Harlo Hadow from Fort Lewis College (He saw only photographs) but he he is from the East and thinks it is a Purple Finch.

This report was written from notes made during X after X observation; from memory

PRINT NAME: Elva Fox SIGNATURE: Elva Fox DATE: 3/20/75
Street Address: 53 Rio Vista Circle Town and State: Durango, Colo. ZIP: 81301

Return to: JACK REDDALL - 4450 South Alton Street, Englewood, Colorado 80110